SHALINI CHOUDHARY

Digital and Integrated Marketing Strategist | Brand, Content, Analytics and Growth | Search and AI Discovery
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PROFILE

Digital and integrated marketing strategist who connects brand, content and demand to commercial outcomes, including a ₹416 crore application pipeline built through organic channels at GUS. Across agency, in-house and education environments since 2016, has advised senior leadership, led teams of 7-10 and worked across the Americas, MENA, EMEA and APAC. Brings depth in search and AI discovery, analytics and conversion, plus pitch, proposal and stakeholder communication experience from GroupM and Ogilvy, including the Ford win. Recently completed an MSc in Marketing Management with Advertising at the University of Leeds (First Class) and was a top-13 UK finalist in the CIM x IBM "The Pitch" 2026.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Integrated Marketing Strategy: Annual roadmaps, go-to-market strategy, cross-functional planning, senior stakeholder advisory, pitches and proposals
Digital and Content: Content strategy, hub-and-spoke architecture, AI-enabled content workflows, multi-brand websites, community and review management
Brand and Market Analysis: Competitor and category analysis, brand visibility, market and pitch analysis, consumer behaviour
Growth, Analytics and Conversion: GA4, Looker Studio, Salesforce-tracked pipeline, A/B testing, conversion optimisation, executive reporting
Search and AI Discovery: SEO, GEO, AEO, technical SEO, international SEO, schema, CMS migrations, AI visibility measurement
Leadership and Communication: Team leadership, operating models, executive briefings, training and mentoring
Platforms: Google Search Console, GA4, SEMrush, Ahrefs, Looker Studio, Salesforce, Drupal, Claude, ChatGPT

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Global University Systems (GUS) | Senior SEO Manager (Digital Portfolio and Content Strategy) Feb 2022 - Sep 2025
Integrated organic, content and growth strategy across multiple education brand websites; team of 7-10; executive reporting to the CBO and marketing director

- Briefed the marketing director and CBO-level leadership weekly on how AI answers were reducing organic clicks. Owned the annual organic roadmap, signed off by the CBO and marketing director, covering site and UX changes, A/B testing, content themes, traffic projections and lead targets, and defended SEO investment by tracing 9,800 leads from SEO-focused pages in Salesforce over one year to 3,200 applications, an application pipeline of roughly ₹416 crore at the ₹13 lakh average programme value, before enrolment conversion.
- Increased citations by 15-20% on restructured deep content pages by front-loading answers and adding FAQ and schema markup, after Ahrefs and SEMrush visibility tests showed low initial AI visibility. Built entity signals and a hub-and-spoke content model for topical authority, and strengthened off-site authority through Reddit and forum answers and genuine reviews on GMB and education portals.
- Reported AI visibility KPIs, including brand mention rate, citation count and share, AI share of voice, AI Overview presence, sentiment and AI referral traffic, alongside organic traffic, engagement and conversion. Built executive dashboards in Looker Studio and a cross-channel reporting framework with the brand team.
- Grew organic traffic 65% year on year with no paid amplification and qualified leads 20% year on year. Lifted lead-to-application conversion by 10-12% and cut bounce rate by 15-20% on a pipeline of 50-60K annual leads converting at roughly 30%, and reduced content production time by 40% through AI-enabled workflows.
- Replatformed two legacy education brand sites onto Drupal with zero ranking loss, under 5% traffic variance and full recovery within one month.
- Led a team of 7-10 (five SEO specialists, two content writers and one analyst) and set up the cross-functional operating model with dev, brand and analytics leads.
- Built audit templates and playbooks for lay and technical audiences, used them to train senior stakeholders and C-suite leaders, and coached junior team members.

GroupM (WPP Group) | Marketing Manager (Digital and Integrated Marketing) Nov 2019 - Jan 2022
Digital marketing and search for global brands including Ford, PepsiCo and Zee5; led 5-6 SEO and marketing specialists

- Owned the website technical analysis and the competitor and market analysis for the winning Ford pitch.
- Grew non-branded organic traffic by 20% at zero budget, outperforming paid on the same queries.
- Delivered international SEO across Americas and MENA with in-house and agency developer teams.
- Ran technical audits covering crawling, indexing and Core Web Vitals, with fixes delivered through developer teams.
- Contributed to pitches, proposals and scoping through brand analysis, proposal building and client presentation, and sized programmes from project scope, deliverables and recurring cadences.

- Presented performance data to client stakeholders and built the investment rationale when budgets were under scrutiny.

JLL (Jones Lang LaSalle) | Digital Marketing Analyst Feb 2019 - Oct 2019

In-house digital marketing and search on a globally indexed domain across EMEA and APAC

- Delivered multi-market SEO across EMEA and APAC on a globally indexed enterprise domain.
- Rolled out entity-level schema across sites with thousands of pages and regional sites of 100-200 pages.
- Built audit templates and playbooks for domestic and global regional sites and shared them for team use.
- Ran competitor and category visibility analysis to prioritise regional content and technical work.

Ogilvy (WPP Group) | Digital Marketing Analyst Sep 2016 - Jan 2019

Digital marketing and search across 10+ client accounts in automotive, luxury, healthcare and e-commerce

- Delivered SEO across 10+ client accounts in automotive, luxury, healthcare and e-commerce.
- Delivered international SEO across Americas and MENA, including large-scale entity-level work on multi-market sites.
- Prepared and reviewed the SEO sections of client pitch decks.
- Produced competitor and category visibility analysis for client accounts and used it to set priorities.

EDUCATION

University of Leeds | MSc Marketing Management with Advertising (First Class) Sep 2025 - Sep 2026

- Shortlisted as one of the top 13 UK teams in the CIM x IBM "The Pitch" 2026 for a £400K go-to-market strategy involving AI-driven commercial marketing.
- Designed a multi-channel growth loop for "Green AI" and pitched it directly to IBM and CIM leadership.

Haridev Joshi University (India) | MA Media Studies (First Class) 2013 - 2015

VOLUNTARY WORK

Marketing Associate, 180 Degrees Consulting Leeds, providing pro-bono strategic marketing consulting.